



Fix the Mix-Up

Find the mistake and fix it

Name: _____

Date: _____

★ I can find the one card that is wrong and fix it.

Bit made a mistake

Bit was making a pattern, but one card is wrong. Finding and fixing a mistake is called **DEBUGGING**. Circle the wrong card, then say what it should be.

Watch Bit — this should go • ▲ • ▲ ...



The 5th card is a square ■, but the pattern needs a circle •. That square is the mix-up.

1 Fix the group

These should all be circles. Circle the one that does not belong, and say what it should be.



2 Fix the pattern

This should go ★ ■ ★ ■ Circle the card that is wrong, and say what it should be.



3 You try

This should go ▲ • ▲ • Circle the card that is wrong, and say what it should be.



Big idea

Finding a mistake and fixing it is called debugging. Every coder debugs — even the best ones make mix-ups and then fix them!



Fix the Mix-Up

Quick facilitation notes & answer key

What this worksheet teaches

Children find the one card that breaks a pattern or group and say what it should be. Spotting and fixing a mistake is a first thinking-skill behind coding — the K-friendly first taste of debugging. No coding experience needed.

Before you start (no computer needed)

No computer — paper and a pencil or crayon. You read each prompt aloud; the child circles the wrong card and names the fix out loud. Optional: build a pattern with blocks, slip in a wrong one, and have children find it.

How to lead it (about 15 minutes)

1. Show them (you do). Read circle, triangle, circle, triangle, square, triangle aloud: "it should be circle-triangle... but here is a square — that is the mix-up." Circle it; it should be a circle.
2. Do one together. Exercise 1 — the triangle does not belong in the circle group.
3. Let them try. Children fix Exercise 2 and Exercise 3 on their own.

Answer key (these are the verified correct answers)

Exercise 1 — circle, circle, triangle, circle → circle the triangle; it should be a circle.

Exercise 2 — star, square, star, square, star, star → circle the last card; it should be a square. Exercise 3 — triangle, circle, triangle, circle, triangle, triangle → circle the last card; it should be a circle.

If children get stuck — and ways to adjust

Watch for: circling more than one. There is exactly one mix-up; have them read to the end first.

Make it easier: use a short 4-card pattern with the mistake near the start.

Make it harder: have the child make a pattern with a mix-up for a partner to find and fix.

Make it active: clap a pattern, slip in a wrong clap, and have children call out the mix-up.

Ontario Kindergarten link (official wording)

Problem Solving and Innovating — children detect and correct an error in a sequence or group.

In plain terms: finding the one thing that is wrong and saying how to fix it — a first taste of debugging.

No reading is needed from the child — you read each prompt aloud; the child answers by drawing or circling.

You'll know it worked when

The child circles the single wrong card in each item and names the correct shape it should be.